

Open Questions — P@SHA Startup Community Platform

A working list of decisions and approvals needed from the Startups & Entrepreneurship Committee, the P@SHA Secretariat, and (where flagged) the Central Executive Committee, before the platform goes from soft-launch to public outreach. Items marked **URGENT** block production launch; others can be settled over the next two weekly calls.

PREPARED FOR: PSEC WEEKLY CALL OWNER: HAMAD PERVAIZ STATUS: AWAITING COMMITTEE INPUT

1. Email & transactional infrastructure

SECRETARIAT · COMMITTEE APPROVAL

1 Which email address should we use as the "from" for all transactional emails sent by the platform? **URGENT**

Today the apply form does not send confirmations; before launch we want submitters to receive an immediate "received your application" email. Candidates: `startups@pasha.org.pk`, `noreply@pasha.org.pk`, or a dedicated `community@pasha.org.pk`. Need an inbox we can authenticate (SPF / DKIM / DMARC).

2 Which inbox should the "Need help?" email on the form route to, and who monitors it day-to-day? **URGENT**

The Apply page currently displays `startups@pasha.org.pk`. We need a person or rotating team responsible for replying within an agreed SLA (e.g. 1 business day). Same applies to bounce-backs from outreach.

3 Approve use of Resend (or alternative) as the transactional email provider?

Resend is our default for BearPlex projects (per-message pricing, easy DKIM). Alternatives: Postmark, SendGrid, AWS SES, Google Workspace SMTP. Decision impacts deliverability, cost, and who holds the API key.

4 Should weekly committee digests be automated (e.g. "5 new applications since last Tuesday")?

Cheap to build once email is configured. Who should receive — full committee, secretariat, or both?

2. Domain & branding

SECRETARIAT · CEC SIGN-OFF IF MAIN DOMAIN AFFECTED

1 What subdomain should the platform live on? URGENT

Today: `pasha-startup-platform.vercel.app`. Recommended: `startups.pasha.org.pk` or `community.pasha.org.pk`. Setting it up takes ~10 minutes once we have CNAME access to the P@SHA DNS. Whoever controls `pasha.org.pk` DNS needs to approve.

2 Approve the platform's visual identity (red accent matching the P@SHA logo, "Pakistan's Startup Directory" framing, "P@SHA verified" badge)?

Usman has reviewed the form and content rounds. Committee sign-off lets us treat the current look as final for the public outreach campaign.

3 What social handles should the platform link to in the footer?

Currently links to `linkedin.com/company/pashapk` and `x.com/PASHA0RG`. If there are dedicated handles for the startup community (separate from the main P@SHA brand), we should link those instead.

4 Should the platform produce its own OG image / share preview, or use the P@SHA master logo?

Affects how the directory looks when shared on LinkedIn, X, WhatsApp. Today we use the P@SHA logo.

3. Codebase, infra & secrets access

SECRETARIAT · COMMITTEE INFORMATIONAL

1 Who from the P@SHA side should have read access to the GitHub repo? URGENT

Today only BearPlex engineers can see `github.com/BearPlex/pasha-startup-platform`. Recommended add: at least one secretariat staff member with admin rights so P@SHA isn't dependent on a single vendor.

2 Who should be a member of the Supabase organisation that hosts the production database? URGENT

Today the project is owned by BearPlex's Supabase org. To keep P@SHA in control of its own data, the secretariat should hold a billing-admin role and one technical staffer should hold a developer-level seat.

3 Who should have admin access to the Vercel project (for deployments, env-vars, custom domains)?

Vercel pricing: free tier covers current traffic. Adding a team seat is paid; recommend one secretariat seat as a long-term backup.

4 What's our policy on offboarding contractors who get access?

Process: revoke GitHub, Vercel, Supabase, magic-link admin email, rotate Resend / API keys. Should be a documented checklist owned by the secretariat.

5 Where do the secrets live and who can rotate them?

Today: Vercel env-vars + my personal credentials file. For a P@SHA-owned platform we should move secret rotation under a P@SHA-controlled 1Password vault or equivalent. Owner needed.

4. Operational ownership

COMMITTEE + SECRETARIAT

1 Who is responsible for vetting incoming applications, even minimally?

URGENT

The platform's automated vetting is a first pass (10 scoring dimensions, four tiers). A human still has to click Approve / Reject / Watchlist in the admin panel. Options: (a) one committee member each week on rotation, (b) the secretariat triages then escalates to the committee weekly, (c) a small sub-committee owns it.

2 Who approves marking a startup as "P@SHA verified"?

URGENT

The verified badge has a legally framed tooltip ("good-faith review, not due-diligence verification") but is still a public signal. We need a clear policy — e.g. "only after a 5-minute LinkedIn / website check by a specific person".

3 What is the SLA from submission to "Approve / Reject" decision?

Recommend 7 days. Beyond that, applicants don't know if their submission is live. Affects automated email copy.

4 Who owns the WhatsApp and Facebook communities the form opts users into?

Form opt-ins are captured today, but no actual group exists yet. We need: a named admin per group, group description / rules, invitation cadence (real-time vs. weekly batch).

5 Who is responsible for the outreach campaign to the 2,481 startups currently in the directory?

All have public-but-cold contact info from StartupConnect.pk. Reaching out requires (i) deciding what we send, (ii) who signs the email, (iii) how we handle responses.

5. Vetting framework & appeals

COMMITTEE APPROVAL

1 Approve the vetting rubric currently encoded in the platform?

5 hard gates (identity, contact, description), 10 scoring dimensions (Product maturity, Funding & traction, Team strength, Market & vertical, International readiness, Revenue model clarity, Ecosystem contribution, Tech moat, Repeatable acquisition, Strategic fit). Thresholds: Featured ≥ 35 , Listed 25–34, Watchlist 15–24, Excluded otherwise.

2 What happens if a founder disputes their tier?

No appeal process exists today. Options: documented form for "request re-review", auto-replied with a 14-day window. Owner: secretariat.

3 When should a startup be removed from the public directory?

Triggers we might support: applicant request, fraud detection, sector violation. Need a documented policy and an audit-logged action.

4 Should P@SHA ICT Award winners be auto-marked verified?

The pashaictawards.com REST API exposes 116 records of historical winners (2022–2025). I built an importer plan but haven't shipped it yet. Approval needed to (i) ingest and (ii) auto-tag those companies as verified.

6. Privacy, terms & liability

COMMITTEE + SECRETARIAT · LEGAL REVIEW RECOMMENDED

1 Approve a privacy policy and terms of service before public outreach.

URGENT

Today there are no such pages. We collect founder name, email, mobile, photo, LinkedIn, pitch deck. At minimum we need: data we collect, why, retention period, how to request deletion. Should be drafted by P@SHA's legal contact, hosted at /privacy and /terms.

2 Confirm the "P@SHA verified" tooltip wording is acceptable to legal.

Current wording: "P@SHA has reviewed this profile in good faith. The badge confirms that basic identifying details have been sighted — it is not a warranty of the company's claims, financials, performance, or compliance, and should not be read as due-diligence or endorsement." Designed to avoid implying P@SHA underwrites the company's claims.

3 Should we publish a contact for data-deletion requests?

Even outside of EU jurisdiction, "remove my company from your directory" is a request we should be ready to honor in <7 days. Owner needed.

4 Data residency — is it OK that the database is in ap-northeast-1 (Tokyo) on Supabase / AWS?

Closer regions like Mumbai or Singapore are available; Tokyo was the default. No regulatory requirement for Pakistan-located data today, but committee may have a preference.

7. Communications, outreach & tone

COMMITTEE

1 Approve the public-facing copy on the landing page and About page.

Usman has reviewed and changed the framing to "Pakistan's Startup Directory" — but final committee blessing lets us treat the copy as locked.

2 Sign off on the outreach email template that will go to the 2,481 startups.

Subject line, sender name, body copy, opt-out language. Will be sent via Resend / chosen ESP once decided in §1.

3 Cadence of outreach — one big blast, or batched (e.g. 200 / day for 2 weeks)?

Slower batching reduces bounce volume + spam-flagging risk. Committee preference?

4 Who signs the outreach email?

Options: PSEC Chair, CEO P@SHA, joint signature. Affects open-rate and how legitimate it looks.

8. Roadmap & deferred features

COMMITTEE PRIORITIES

1 Founder-facing login: should founders be able to edit their own profile after submission?

Today, only admins can edit. Adds complexity (passwordless auth, profile claim, anti-takeover checks). Worth doing post-launch.

2 Public submissions visibility — should the listing show "Pending review" entries, or only "Approved"?

Today the public directory shows the curated databank of 2,481 startups; new submissions appear in admin only until approved. Confirm intent.

3 Mentor matching, jobs board, events calendar — committee priorities?

Several adjacent features would naturally fit on the platform. Worth a 5-minute discussion to set 6-month roadmap.

4 Urdu / bilingual content?

Deferred today. Committee call on whether this is desirable.

9. Reporting back to the committee

COMMITTEE + SECRETARIAT

1 Should the platform produce a weekly or monthly report for PSEC?

Easy to wire up: submissions received, breakdown by sector / city, current tier mix, top engagement signals. Email or shared dashboard.

2 Should aggregated metrics be reported to the CEC quarterly?

If yes, what KPIs matter — total companies, tier distribution, female-founded %, accelerator-affiliated %, regional distribution?

10. Sponsorship & commercial

CEC SIGN-OFF

1 Should the platform have any sponsor logos / partner mentions?

e.g. HBL (current title sponsor of the ICT Awards) — committee call on whether their logo appears here too.

2 Is there an appetite to charge for "Featured" tier or for premium listing perks?

Not built today; defer until we see usage patterns. Worth committee discussion in advance.

Working document — last revised 21 May 2026. Prepared by BearPlex for the PSEC weekly call. Items marked URGENT block production launch.